

Distant opposition is about timing

Endgame Technique

THE IDEA

Kings can oppose each other from farther away. On the same file or rank, an odd number of intervening squares can preserve the opposition relationship as they approach, provided the route and pawn moves permit it. Always connect the geometry to entry squares.

WORKED EXAMPLE

White king e2 and Black king e6 have three squares between them. If Black must move and no pawn moves change the tempo, White can try to preserve the relationship while approaching. Other routes or obstacles may change the result.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What can break a simple opposition calculation?

ANSWER AND REASONING

A reserve pawn move, a diagonal approach, a blocked square, or a tactical pawn capture. Calculate actual legal routes rather than relying only on the count of intervening squares.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Track available tempi as well as king alignment.